

VU-REC - WORK PLAN from January 2026 - March 2027

YEAR ↓	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
2025				Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate – FULL REVIEW	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate – FULL REVIEW	Acceptance & Review-VACATION CYCLE	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate – FULL REVIEW	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics Review Clearance Certificate	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics Review Clearance Certificate	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics Review Clearance Certificate	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics Review Clearance Certificate	Acceptance, Review & Issuance of Ethics Review Clearance Certificate STATUS REPORT for review Vacation
2026	Acceptance Only	Review of applications received in January 2026	Acceptance Only	Review of applications received in February 2026	Acceptance Only	Acceptance Only	Review of applications received in May and June 2026	Acceptance Only	Review of applications received in August 2026	INTERNAL WORK	Acceptance Only	Review of applications received in November 2026
	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in December 2025 (due to pendency)	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in February 2026 (due to pendency)	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in April 2026 (due to pendency)	VACATION CYCLE	STATUS REPORT review Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in July 2026 (due to pendency)	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate	INTERNAL WORK	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in Sept and Oct 2026 (due to pendency)	STATUS REPORT review Issuance of the Ethics review certificate for the application reviewed in December Vacation
2027		Review of applications received in January 2027	Acceptance Only	<i>Please note:</i> 1. During the acceptance-only cycle, all prospective researchers can submit their Ethics Review Applications until the Monday of the Fourth week of the month, and only in the prescribed (new) application format. 2. Researchers who have received ethics review clearance are requested to submit their research status reports every three months, using the format provided by the VU-REC. 3. Researchers who have received ethics review clearance are requested to extend their validity by submitting a request at least one month before the expiry date, using the prescribed format.								
	Acceptance Only		Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in February 2026 (due to pendency)									
	Issuance of Ethics review clearance certificate for application reviewed in December 2026 (due to pendency)	Issuance of Ethics review certificate for the application received in January 2027	Task completion and points to note for the next REC									